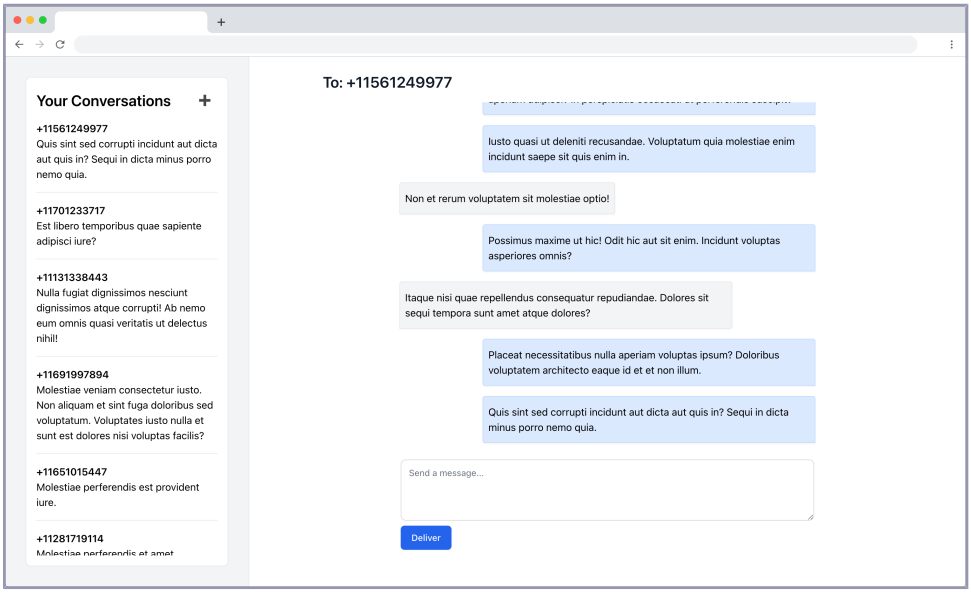
A bit of magic is going on here. Phoenix will use the PhoneAppWeb.MessageHTML module when the PhoneAppWeb.MessageController calls the render function. If the request was for JSON data, then PhoneAppWeb.MessageJSON would be used instead. This lets you build a single controller that responds to both HTML and JSON data through the relevant views. (This is similar to Rail's render method.)

The embed_templates/1 function tells the view to use external HTML templates. You can also use inline HTML with the ~H[16] sigil, but our views are large enough to warrant separate files. You'll see how to use ~H later in this chapter.

You already copied the .html.heex templates earlier in this chapter, so the views are already in your project.

Start your server with iex -S mix phx.server and load http://localhost:4004/messages. You'll see a list of conversations on the left-hand sidebar and a loaded conversation in the center, as in the following figure.



If you try to submit the form, you'll see it doesn't work. We'll add that next!

Take Action on User Input

We don't have a create action defined, so our form raises "function PhoneAppWeb.MessageController.create/2 is undefined or private" when we submit it.

16. https://hexdocs.pm/phoenix_live_view/Phoenix.Component.html#sigil_H/2